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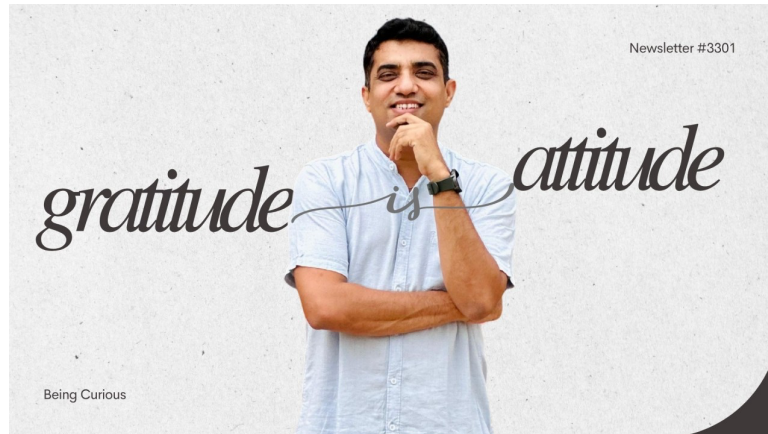
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## Gratitude is an Attitude

**Vikas Surani**

Global Vice President – Growth | TEDx Speaker | IIMA



July 21, 2025

Hey Curious Minds,

Let me tell you about a moment I had last week. I was rushing through my morning, already mentally in my first meeting & board meet super priority, when something made me stop. I took a breath and said a quiet "thank you" before the day began. It's this small ritual I've developed—like setting the right intention before you lead.

It got me thinking: what if gratitude isn't just feel-good fluff, but actually one of the practical leadership tools you can use?

Think about it like building trust—it's not one big moment, but small, consistent actions. When I thank my partner before we eat, when I acknowledge a team member who quietly solved a problem, when I offer help before asking for anything—these aren't just nice gestures. They're building something bigger.

Harvard Business Review found that employees who feel appreciated are 50% more productive. But here's what the research doesn't capture: when you practice gratitude as a leader, it changes how you handle tough moments.

Last month, an engagement my team leader was leading hit a major wall. Old me would have focused on what went wrong. Instead, I found myself thinking about what was working: a committed team, stakeholders who trusted me, the chance to innovate under pressure. That shift didn't

trusted me, the chance to innovate under pressure. That shift didn't solve the problem, but it gave me the clarity to lead us through it.

Gratitude isn't about being the "nice" leader. It's about staying curious. When you're grateful, you're open to solutions you might miss otherwise. You notice strengths in people. You ask better questions. You see opportunities where others see obstacles.

Some days, gratitude is just appreciating that a difficult conversation went better than expected. But even those small moments shift something fundamental—for you and your team.

As leaders, we set the tone. When we lead with gratitude, we give others permission to do the same.

How does gratitude show up in the way you lead?

Stay curious, Vikas

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Thanks for sharing, Vikas

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**Vikas Surani**  Author  
Global Vice President – Growth | TEDx Speaker | IIMA

[Rizwana Tabrez](#) glad it resonates

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**Gaurang Rathod**  · 1st  
Built brands across India with a distribution-first mindset | Owned ...

It is a good perspective. Thanks for sharing.

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**Vikas Surani**  Author  
Global Vice President – Growth | TEDx Speaker | IIMA

[Gaurang Rathod](#) glad it resonates

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**Deepti Rathore**  · 1st  
Talent Acquisition Partner

[Vikas Surani](#) - This is a valuable perspective. I would argue that it encourages initiative and accountability among employees. They are likely to go the extra mile, even during challenging times.

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**Vikas Surani**  Author  
Global Vice President – Growth | TEDx Speaker | IIMA

5mo ...

**Deepti Rathore** Indeed! Gratitude fuels ownership — it brings out the best, even in the toughest times.

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**Nitin Bawsay**  • 1st  
Growth Generalist

5mo ...

This is a good statement and we humans first make it a habit and that then becomes an attitude. Liked it 😊

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**Vikas Surani**  Author  
Global Vice President – Growth | TEDx Speaker | IIMA

5mo ...

**Nitin Bawsay** indeed, behaviour follows the identity nitin ji

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